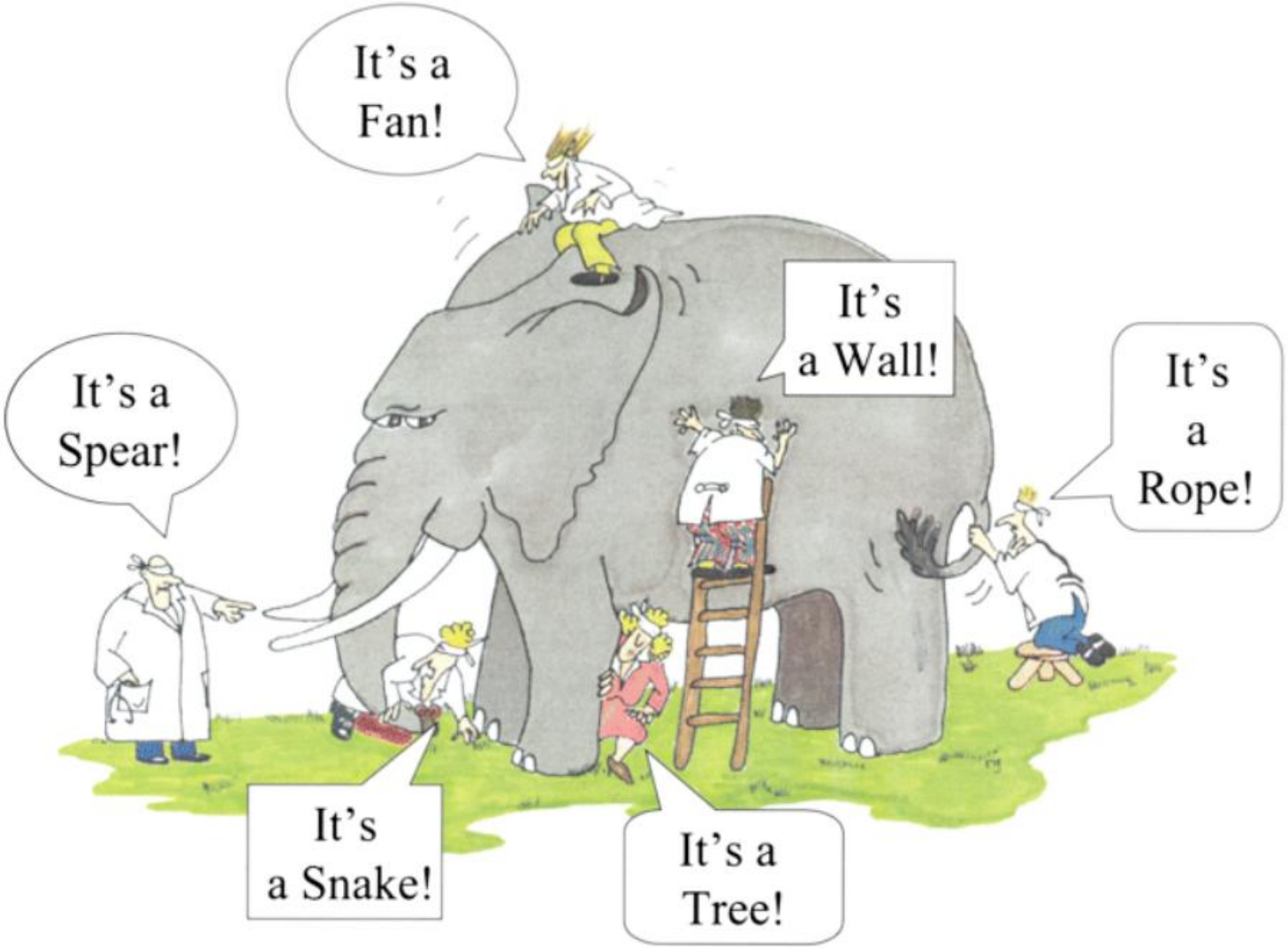
The whole is greater than the sum of its parts



Essential Agile/Scrum

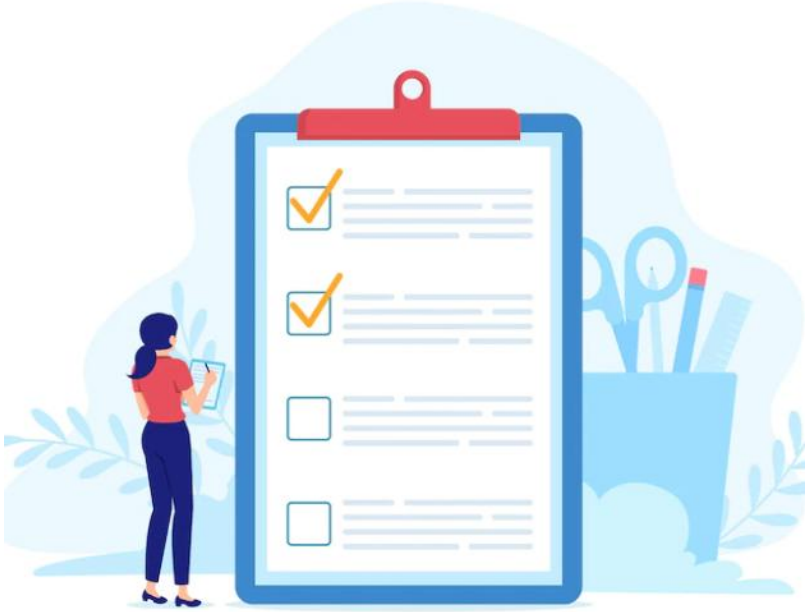
INTRO

TEAM

EVENTS

ARTIFACTS

Essential Agile/Scrum



INTRO

- Traditional vs Scrum/Agile

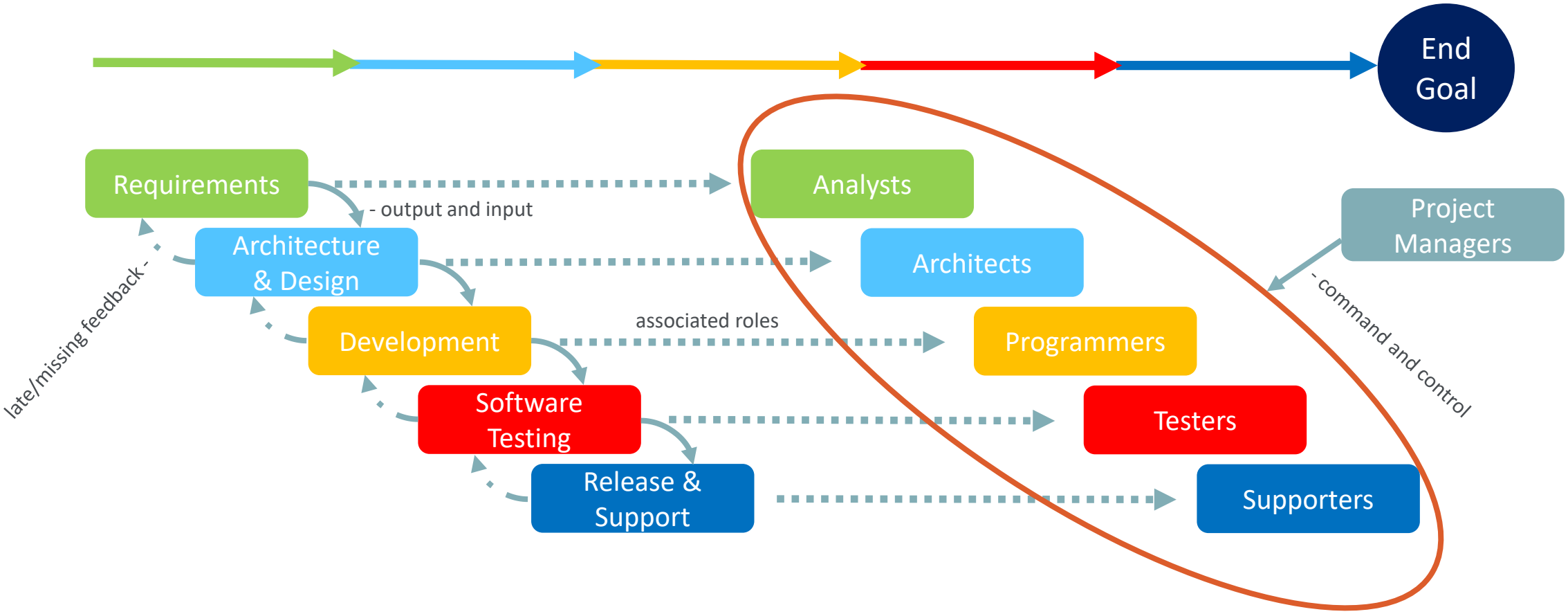
TEAM

EVENTS

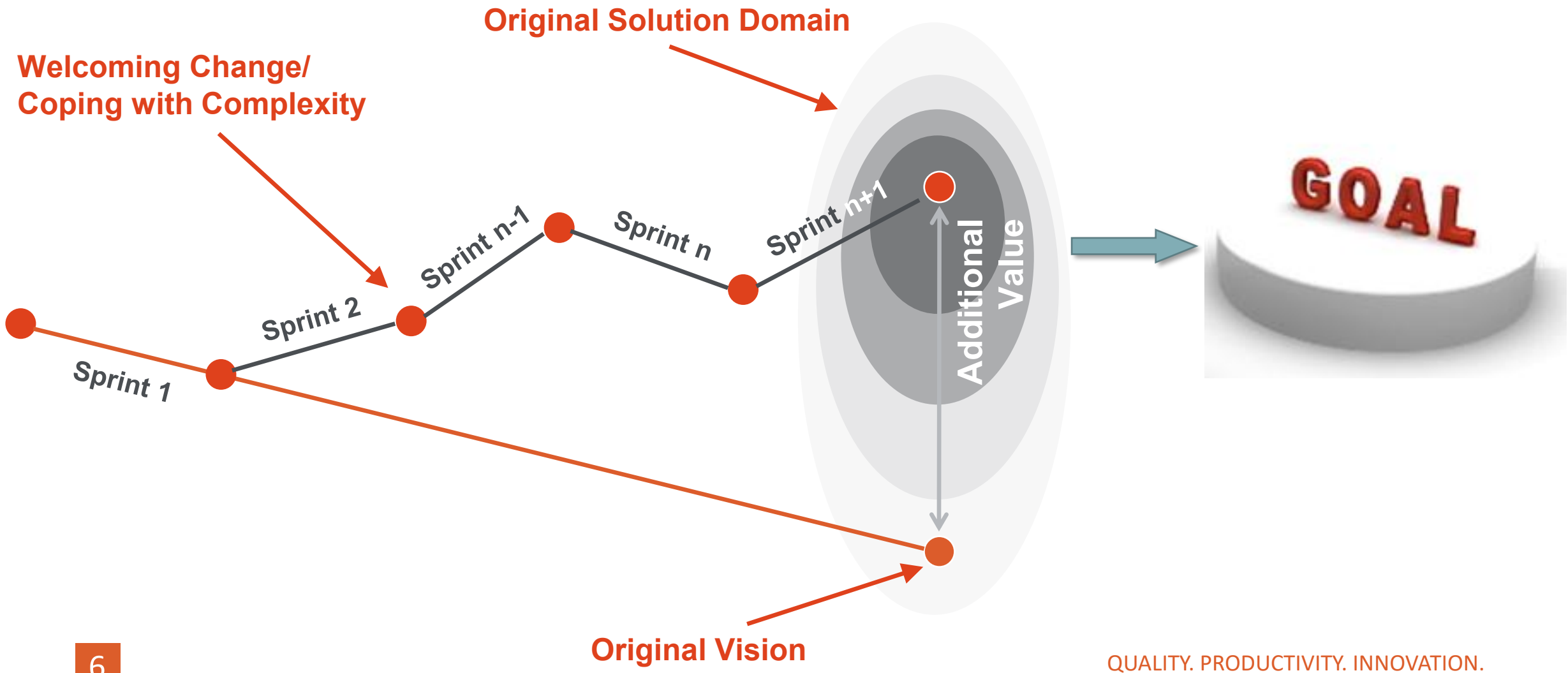
ARTIFACTS

Traditional approach

Waterfall mindset – Everybody is looking for their part in the project, concentrating only on inputs and outputs of their layer, sometimes forgetting the end goal or the context they are operating in.

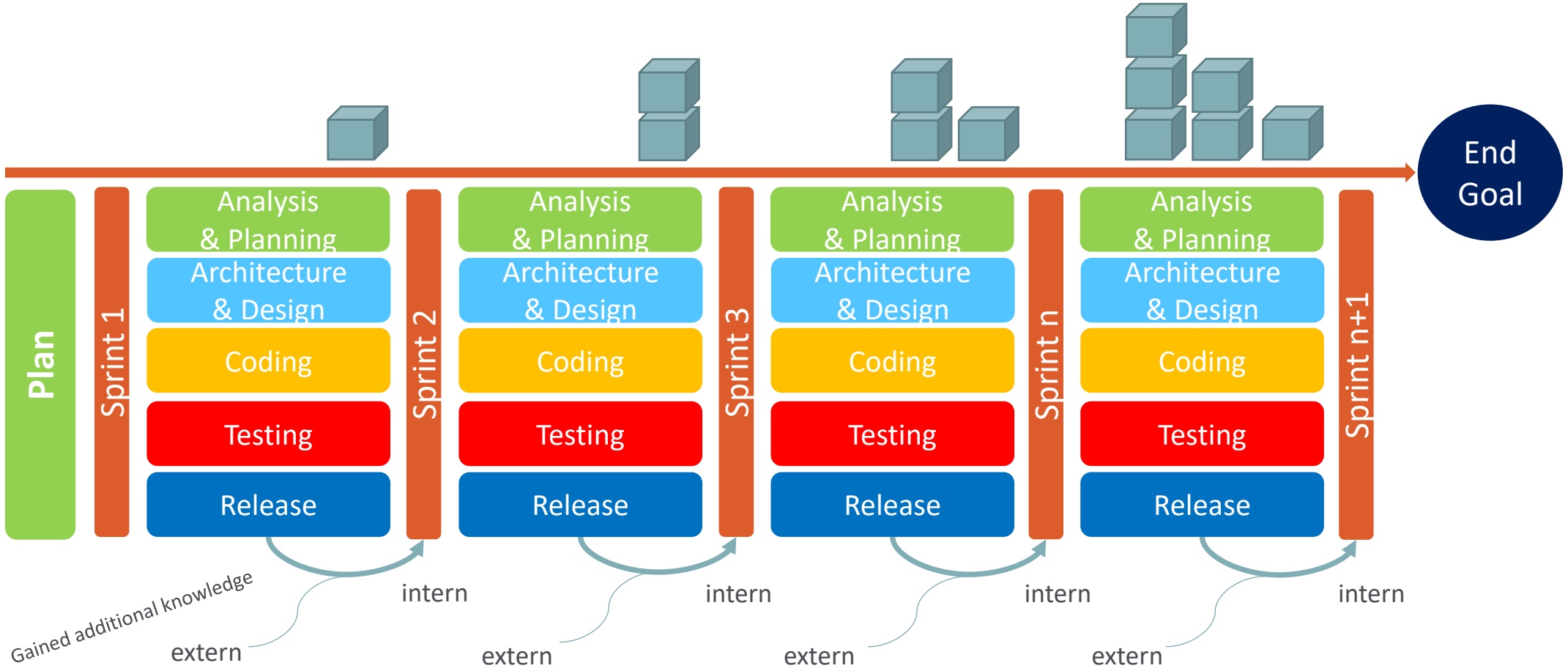


Agile Processes are Goal Oriented and Adaptive



Agile approach

Agile mindset – team members, with skills across all layers, work collaboratively, doing their best in any circumstance, adapting in order to achieve the common end goal.



THE AGILE Manifesto

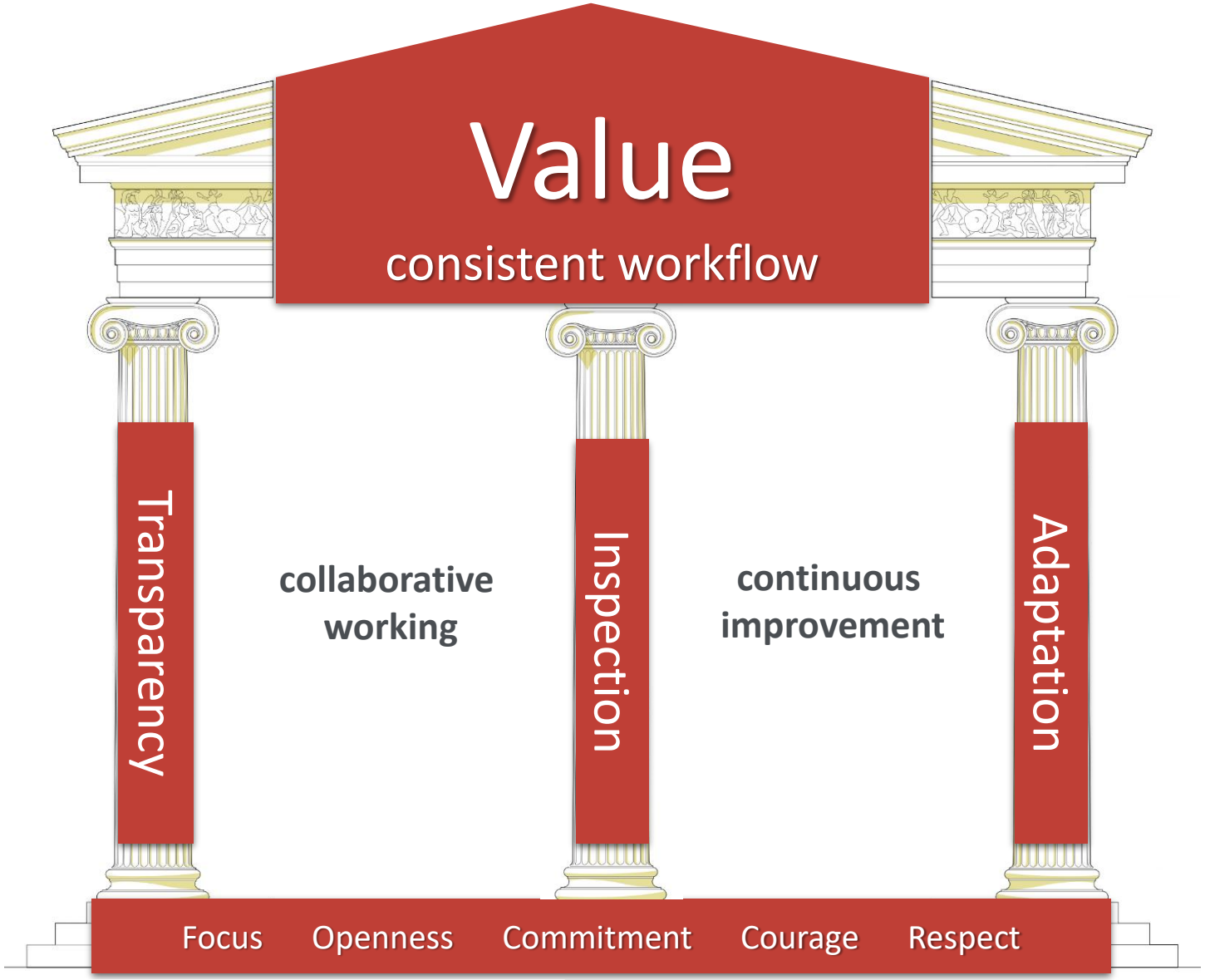
INDIVIDUALS AND INTERACTIONS over processes and tools

RESPONDING TO CHANGE over following a plan

WORKING SOFTWARE over comprehensive documentation

CUSTOMER COLLABORATION over contract negotiation

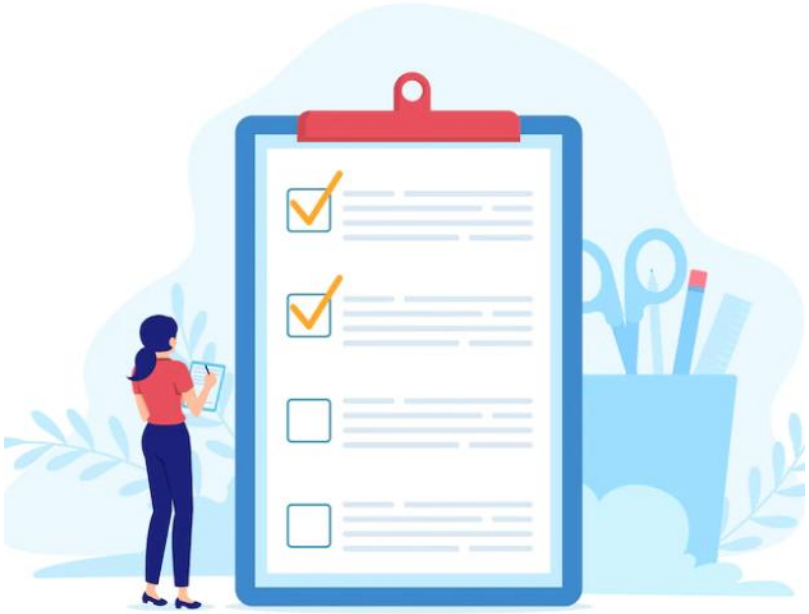
Agile Values & Pillars



Lean | Empiricism

Doing Agile
Process is easier to imitate
we need both
are we missing something under the surface?
Values are harder to embody
Being Agile

Essential Agile/Scrum



TEAM

- Product Owner
- Developers
- Scrum Master

INTRO

EVENTS

ARTIFACTS

Scrum Team

Main Focus

Deliver products iteratively and incrementally

Maximize opportunities for feedback

Ensure a potentially useful version of working product is always available

Characteristics

Cross-functional: skills and competencies in each of the disciplines needed

Self-organized: ability to decide inside the team how best to accomplish work

Empowered: autonomy to plan and manage their own work

Accountable: responsibility to deliver a working piece of software at the end of the iteration

Product Owner

Developers

Scrum Master

Product Owner

Is the Navigator. Envisioning the product - Maximizing the value of the product. Single voice to make product decision. Maximizing the work of the development team

Responsibilities:

- Manages Product Backlog focusing on What rather than How
- Accountable for managing the Product Backlog even if he choses to delegate this activity
- Represents all stakeholders: End Users, Senior Management, Operational Staff, Domain Experts, Architects, Auditors

Developers

Responsible of delivering a potentially shippable increment of “Done” functionality each Sprint

Responsibilities:

- Commit on selected number of features to be built in a sprint
- Focuses on technical excellence
- Presents each sprint achievements in a form of a demo
- Continuously looks to improve their efficiency and effectiveness
- Contributes and helps the PO with Backlog refinement

3 to 9 members

Attributes of a good Development/Build Team

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Self-organized: autonomy to determine how and when to complete its work

No titles other than Developer: "Unus pro omnibus, omnes pro uno"

Agile attitude: applying 5 values of Scrum (Commitment, Focus, Respect, Openness, Courage). Inspect and adapt

Sitting together: maximizing value of collaboration

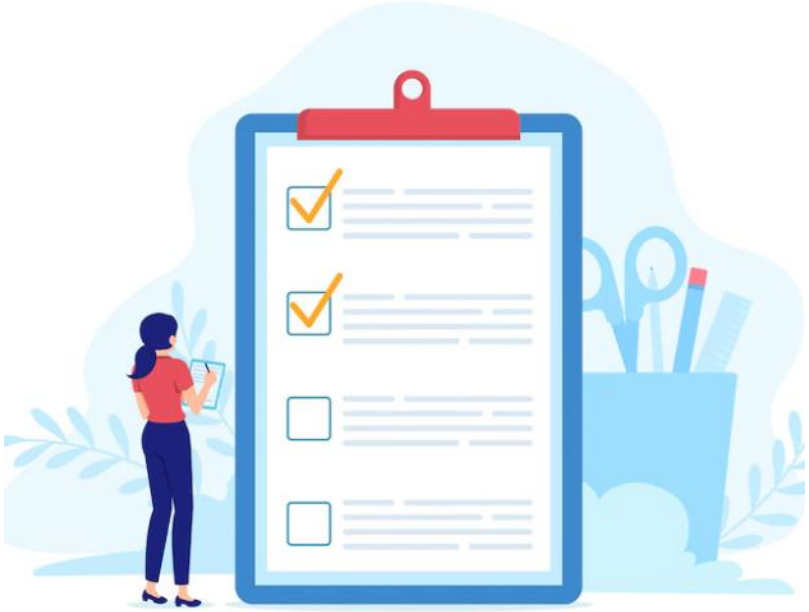
Scrum Master

Servant leader for the team. Supports the team managing Scrum Processes

Responsibilities:

- Enacting Scrum values and practices
- Ensures the team is fully functional and productive
- Shield the team and removes impediments
- Facilitates Scrum ceremonies
- Enable close cooperation across all roles and functions

Essential Agile/Scrum



EVENTS

- Backlog Refinement (Activity)
- Sprint Planning
- Daily Scrum
- Sprint Review
- Sprint Retrospective

INTRO

TEAM

ARTIFACTS

Backlog Refinement - Why

The process of adding detail, estimates, and prioritize items in the Product Backlog. The goal is to create Product Backlog items that meet the Definition of Ready

This meeting will help the team to:

- Have the top items in the Product Backlog ready for the next Sprint Planning meeting
- Have a better estimation of the work to be done.
- Have enough clarity for the next pieces of work so that we can plan the next sprint and eliminate waste

INDEPENDENT
NEGOTIABLE
VALUABLE
ESTIMABLES
SMALL
TESTEABLES

Refinement usually consumes no more than 10% of the capacity of the Build Team

Sprint Planning - Why

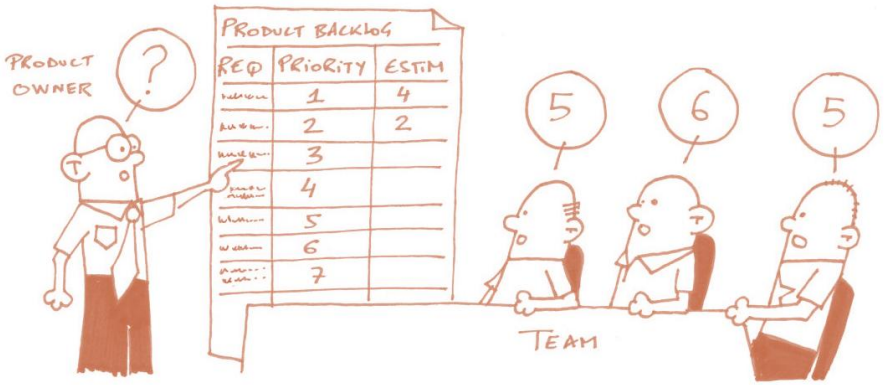
A collaborative effort so that the Agile Team Members:

Reach the same transparency over the top items ordered in the Product Backlog

Define the vision for the Sprint - by crafting a common Goal that would be respected over Sprint's duration

Establish and unify build team's plan of work for the Sprint

Define what will be delivered and how will the work be done



Time-boxed: 4h per 2 weeks sprint (Usually shorter/longer for shorter/longer sprints)

Sprint Planning - How

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Practices

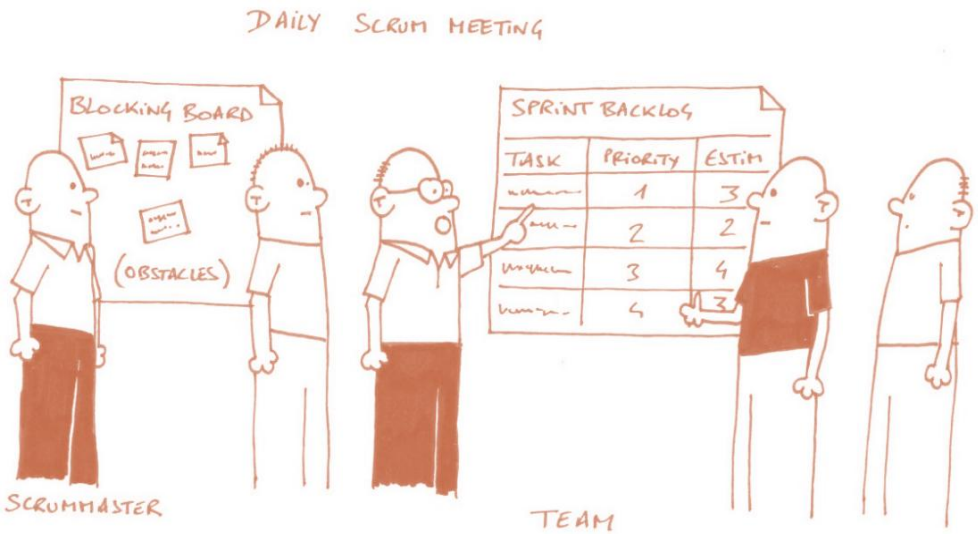
- The PO discusses the objective for the Sprint and the Product Backlog items
- The Developers work to forecast the functionality that will be developed during the Sprint
- For this meeting, the team needs the prioritized product backlog, the last product Increment, past performance of the team (velocity) and the capacity of the Build Team for the Sprint

From this session the team will get the sprint goal and the forecast of the items that will be delivered (sprint backlog)

Daily Scrum

The developers meet to discuss their progress against the plan - obtain understanding of what work has been done and what work remains

- The team can adjust the plan in order to meet the Sprint Goal and complete Sprint Backlog items
- Identify impediments to development for removal
- Improve communications
- Eliminate other meetings
- Highlight and promote quick decision-making
- Improve Team's level of knowledge

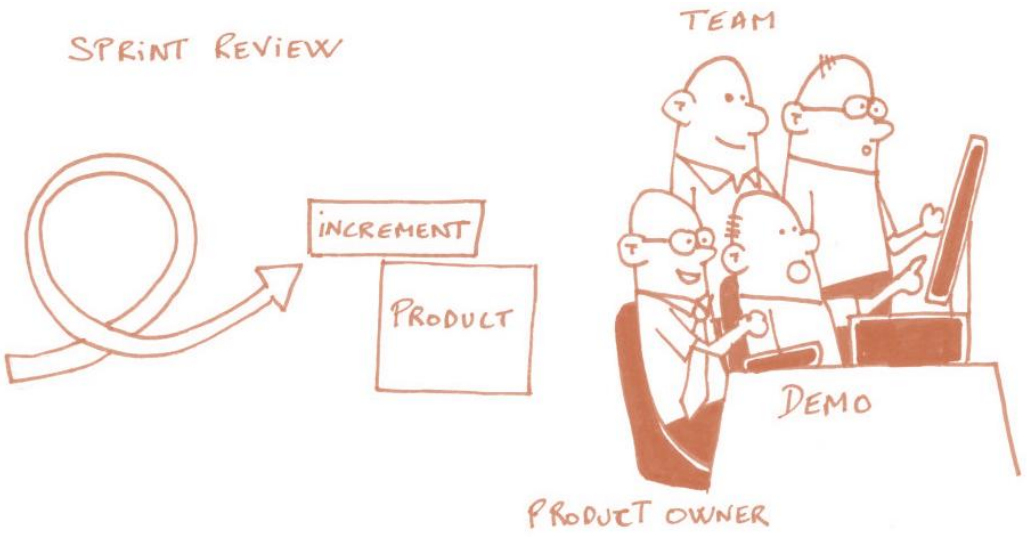


Time-boxed: 15 minutes

Sprint Review

A close collaboration between the Agile Team and stakeholders of what has been done in the sprint. The stakeholders can see how the product was improved by the addition of new features and functionalities

- All participants collaborate in identifying items from PB that bring the most value
- A meeting when we learn from what it has been done / experienced during the sprint
- Outward focused. How can we improve our product?
- Elicit feedback and foster collaboration

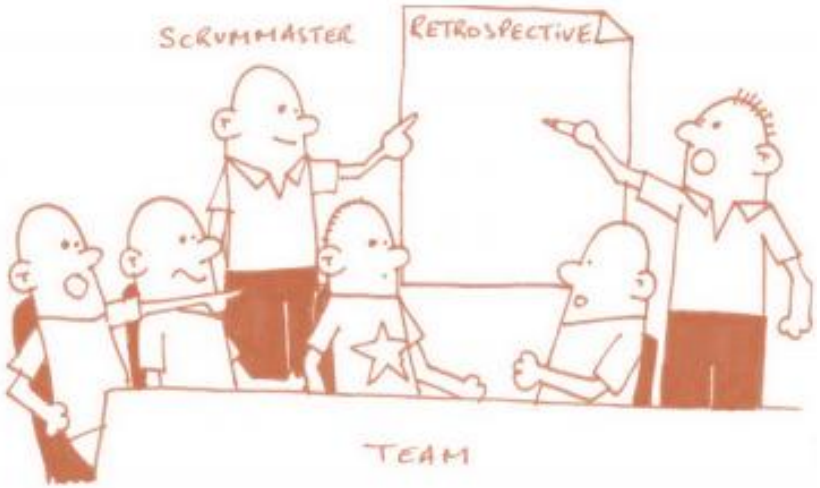


Time-boxed: 2h per 2 weeks sprint (Usually shorter/longer for shorter/longer sprints)

Sprint Retrospective

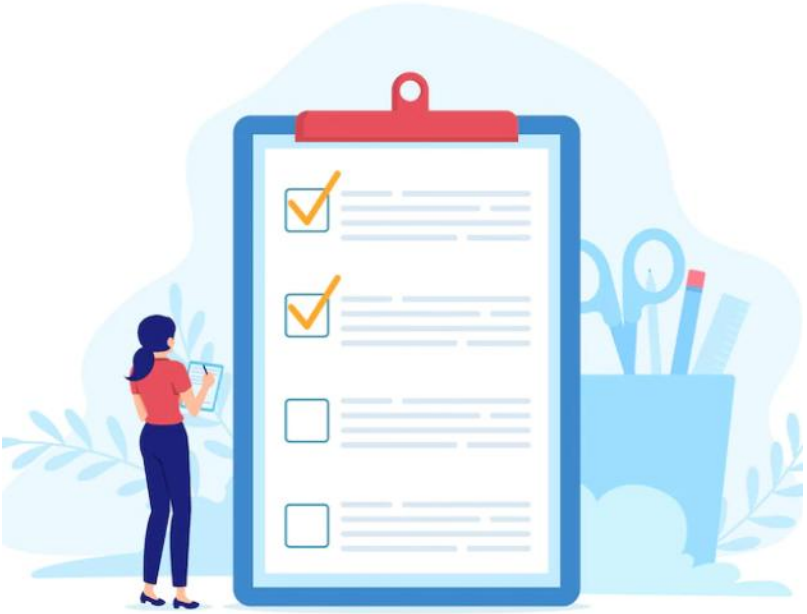
Helps teams – even great ones – to keep improving. Enables whole-team learning, act as catalyst for change, and generate action

- Focus on inspecting and adapting the most valuable asset in a software organization, the team itself
- Opportunity to change behaviour and team culture
- Safe place for team members to share constructively feedback



Time-boxed: 1.5h per 2 weeks sprint (Usually shorter/longer for shorter/longer sprints)

Essential Agile/Scrum



ARTIFACTS

- Product Backlog
- Sprint Backlog
- Retrospective Notes

INTRO TEAM EVENTS

Product Backlog

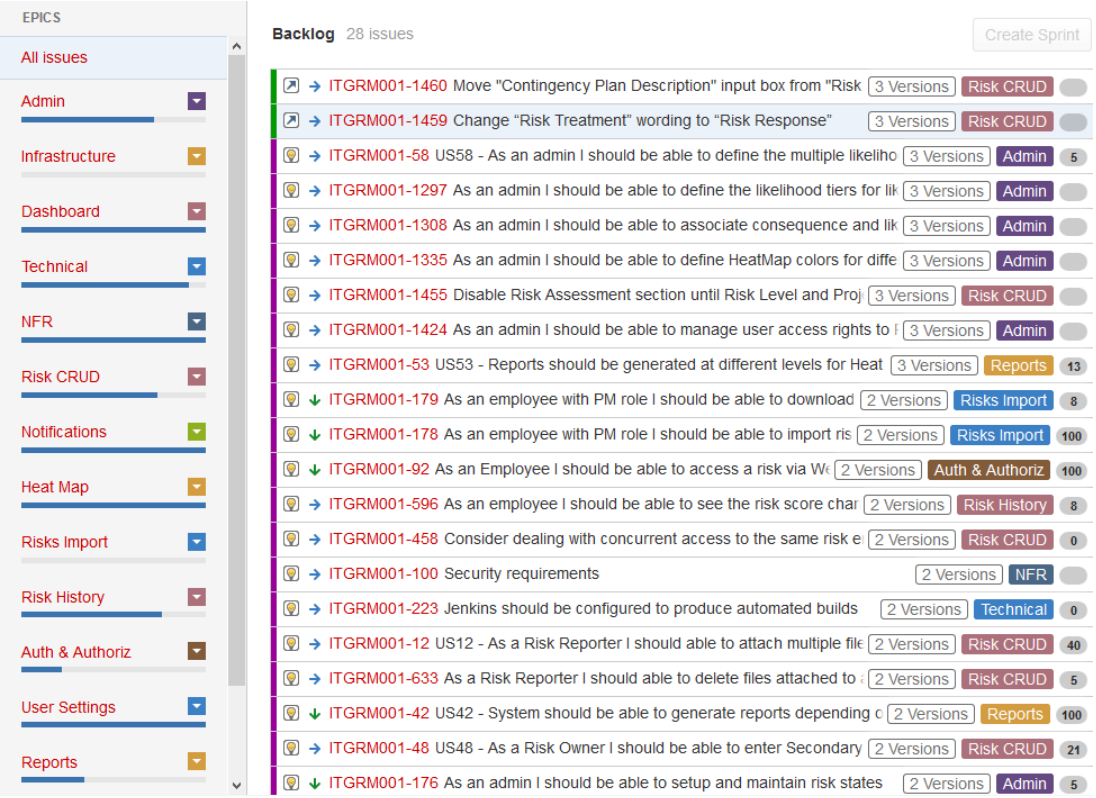
A high level ordered list of customer requirements for the project that is owned by the Product Owner

The only source of information for product scope and shape

Identifies the business-critical features (80/20 rule)

Provides transparency between two worlds, client and contractor/partner

Helps the Team to understand the business (product) goals and reasoning to achieve a valuable outcome



Sprint Backlog

Is a subset of User Stories selected by the team during the Sprint Planning - represents the workload forecasted at the beginning of the Sprint - if the Product Backlog focuses on WHAT and WHY, Sprint Backlog focuses on part of WHAT and HOW

Team needs a plan for delivering the product Increment and realizing the Sprint Goal

Team needs an artefact to reflect an up-to-date snapshot of the sprint's progress and facilitate the day-to-day planning

Team tracks this total work remaining to project the likelihood of achieving the Sprint Goal

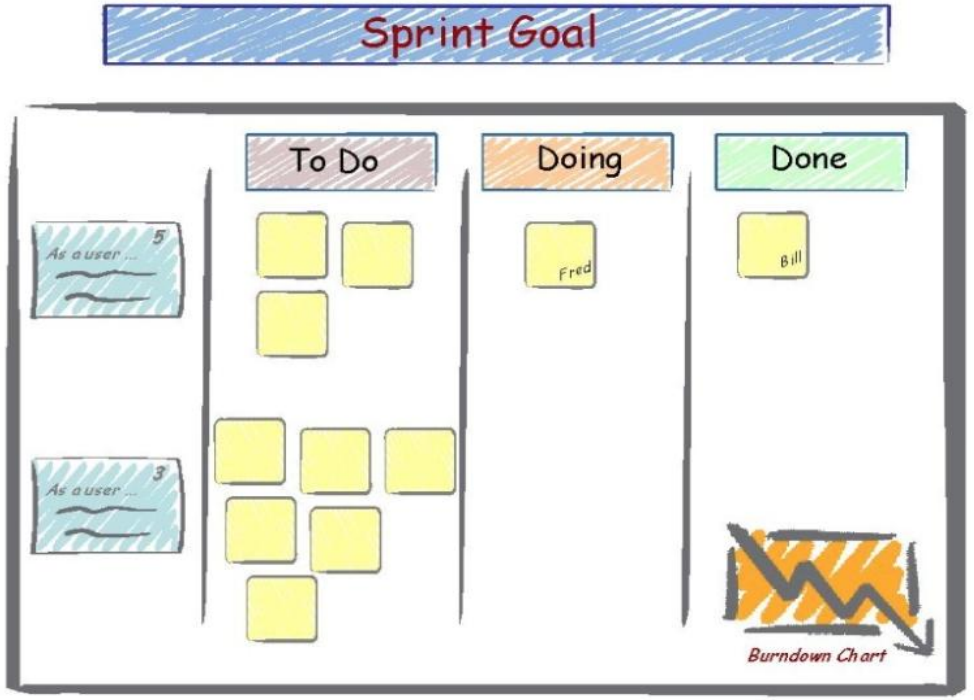


image courtesy of yorkesoftware.com/2015/01/30/explaining-the-taskboard/

Retrospective Notes and Actions

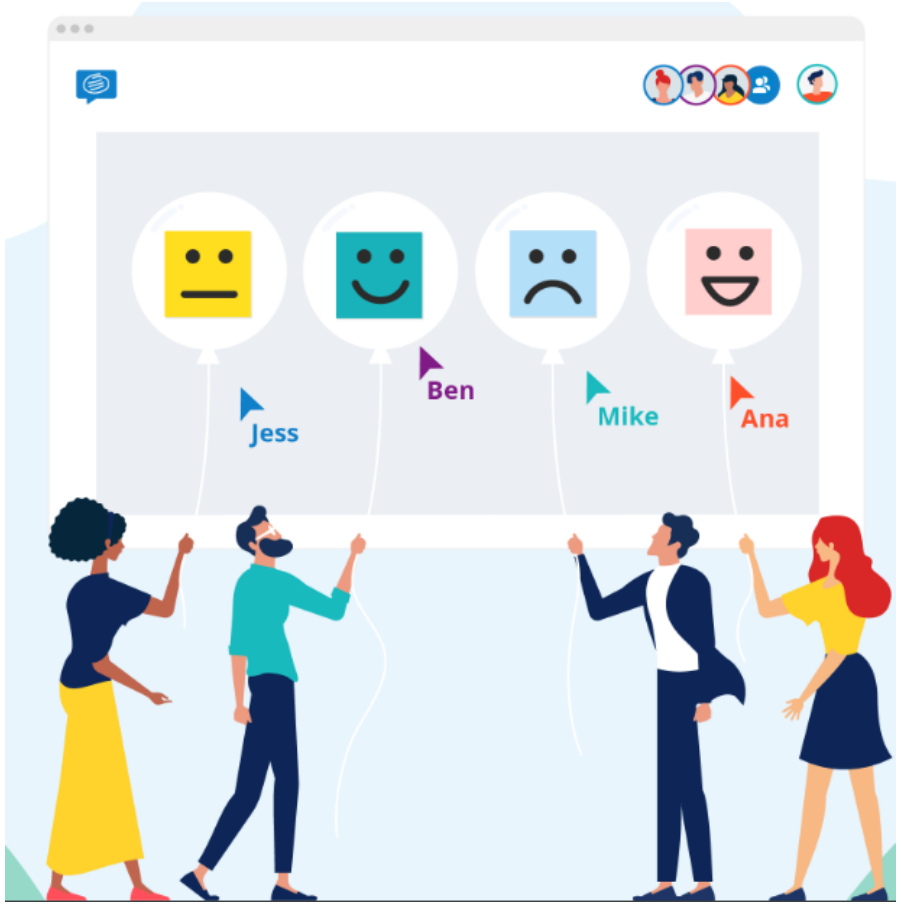
Helps to learn how to work more efficiently as a team - The adaptation is at the team level not at the individual level

It is the key to the adaptive process

The goal is consensus on what to do next - it's a constant reminder of the need to continuously improve, to always be moving forward

Helps team - even great ones - keep improving

The expected output is two lists of action items, one for the team (inside), one for the Scrum master (outside: involving the rest of the organization)



Thank you!

Attributions

This material draws inspiration from a massive community of Agile enthusiasts, our own experience and that of many clients and companies we've engaged with through the years.

People that have inspired us through many trainings, workshops , articles and webinars: Mike Cohn, Jeff Sutherland, Henrik Kniberg, Ken Schwaber, Roman Pichler, Anna Forss, Serge Beaumont, Mike Beedle and many others we've not intentionally forgot

Sites and whitepapers with excellent knowledge: www.scrumguides.org ; www.agilealliance.org; www.mountaingoatsoftware.com; www.scrumalliance.org; www.controlchaos.com; www.implementingscrum.com; www.jeffsutherland.org; www.agileforall.com; www.infoq.com; www.rapidscrum.com; www.slideshare.net; www.agile42.com; scrum.jeffsutherland.com; www.agilemanifesto.org; www.scrum.org; www.wikipedia.org; www.projectmanagement.com; www.romanpichler.com; www.agilesherpa.org; www.cathycarleton.com; www.implementingscrum.com; www.gantthead.com;

Books that have added invaluable knowledge: Ken Schwaber - Agile Project Management with Scrum; Mike Cohn - Agile Estimating and Planning; Mike Cohn – Introduction to user stories; Roman Pichler - Agile product management with Scrum; Anna Forss - Confessions of a serial product owner; Ken Schwaber - The Enterprise and Scrum; Mike Cohn - User Stories Applied; Carl Larson and Frank LaFasto - Teamwork; Serge Beaumont - Practical Tools for the Product Owner: Focus, Value, Flow; Jim Highsmith - Agile Project Management; Jeff Patton - Story Maps; Mike Cohn - Succeeding with Agile; 37 Signals: Getting Real; Jeff Sutherland - The Power of Scrum ; Tobias Mayer - Scrum Roles; Donald Reinertsen - The Principles of Product Development Flow; C. Jakobsen and J. Sutherland - Scrum and CMMI – Going from Good to Great; Donald Reinertsen - Managing The Design Factory; Scrum Sense – What every product owner should know; Ken Schwaber, Beedle Mike - Agile Software Development with Scrum;

RSA Animate - Drive: The surprising truth about what motivates us video: http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=u6XAPnuFjJc